pursue a policy of transformational cooperation with China. Given, however, the imperatives of maintaining a stable external environment to enable domestic economic transformation and avoiding a precipitate two-front challenge, India is likely to persist with instrumental cooperation. While short-term appeasement driven by weakness, vulnerability, or unfavourable international circumstances is a possibility, India is unlikely to bandwagon with the currently more powerful China because the race for wealth and power between the Chinese hare and the Indian tortoise is not yet over, and India is expected to catch up with China over the long term.[119] Competition is thus likely to remain the underlying motif in India's policy towards China, even while cooperation is pursued for the instrumental purpose of maintaining peace and stability. Whether competition and cooperation remain in balance or India steps up its internal and external balancing efforts would be contingent upon the scope and intensity of the threat that China poses in the coming years.

Notes

1 China's Xinjiang province also shares a border with Indian territory; one portion of its border is with the Indian Union Territory of Ladakh, and the other is with Gilgit-Baltistan, which is under Pakistan's occupation. China's Tibet Autonomous Region also shares portions of its border with Bhutan, Nepal, and Myanmar.

2 Gopal, Sarvepalli, ed. (1992) *Selected Works of Jawaharlal Nehru: Second Series* [hereafter SWJN-SS], Volume 13, New Delhi: Jawaharlal Nehru Memorial Fund, p. 260.

3 Raghavan, Srinath (2010) *War and Peace in Modern India: A Strategic History of the Nehru Years*, Ranikhet, Permanent Black, pp. 231, 233.

4 Palat, Madhavan K., ed. (2015) *SWJN-SS*, Volume 60, New Delhi, Jawaharlal Nehru Memorial Fund, pp. 20, 55.

5 *P. N. Haksar Papers*, 3rd Instalment, Subject File No. 220, New Delhi, Nehru Memorial Museum and Library, p. 124.